

Orion

Portfolio Intelligence Platform — a five-lens teardown

Subject: Orion — single-page, multi-asset portfolio intelligence web app

Scope: Everyday user · Power user · VC · Big-Tech PM · Brutally honest critic

Method: Source code, UI screenshots & feature audit (orion.html, findings engine, pricing & AI backends)

Prepared for: Karl · **Date:** June 2, 2026

Posture: Adversarial. Treated as a real check-writing decision.

6.0 / 10 — **blended panel score**

A genuinely impressive **product** wearing the body of a weekend prototype. Private-banking-grade analytics, no business around them. Verdict in full on the final page.

What Orion Actually Is

Orion is a single static HTML file (~308 KB) that turns a manually-entered or CSV-imported portfolio into an institutional-style intelligence dashboard. It is unusually ambitious for its form factor. Observed feature surface:

Inputs & coverage

- Seven asset classes: equities/ETFs, cash, **bonds**, real estate, crypto, commodities, and debts/liabilities
- Broker CSV/Excel import with column mapping
- ISIN → ticker resolution via OpenFIGI; live + historical quotes via Yahoo Finance
- Multi-currency, with FX normalization to USD

Intelligence & analytics

- AI "morning briefing," a "House View" repositioning memo, and a free-text Copilot
- Risk engine: health score, factor exposure, concentration analysis
- Stress Lab: single-factor shocks, custom shock sliders, a -300/+400bps rate-sensitivity curve
- Investor-profile questionnaire driving a target allocation & repositioning gap
- Findings engine — incl. **US-situs estate-tax** exposure & UCITS re-wrap logic

The central tension of this entire review: the analytical depth here rivals products built by 30-person fintech teams, but it sits on a no-login, no-account, no-payment, browser-only architecture that depends on an undocumented, rate-limited free Yahoo Finance endpoint. The intelligence is venture-grade. The business around it does not yet exist.

The Everyday User

"I have a Trading 212 account and a couple of ETFs. I just want to know if I'm okay."

First impression. The landing copy ("Your wealth, intelligently understood") is confident and the visual design is clean and modern — closer to Linear or Mercury than to a typical finance tool. That earns goodwill in the first ten seconds. The treemap "Wealth Map" and the donut sector breakdown are genuinely satisfying to look at.

Where it works. CSV import lowers the wall meaningfully — if my broker export is clean, I get a populated dashboard fast. The health score and the plain-English morning briefing give me the single thing I came for: a verdict. The risk questionnaire ("≈2 min") is the right length and the "skip — just the risk score" escape hatch is good product instinct.

Where it breaks. The bond entry screen is the canary. It asks an everyday user for ISIN, coupon, maturity, face value, quantity, *and* current price as a percentage — and then punishes them with a red **"No tradeable Yahoo symbol mapped for this ISIN"** error they cannot resolve. That is a dead end that makes a normal person feel stupid, which is fatal. More broadly: nothing is saved. There is no account, so if I close the tab, my portfolio is gone (or trapped in one browser). For a tool I'm meant to return to every morning, that is a contradiction at the core of the value proposition.

Would I keep using it? Probably not past week one — not because it's bad, but because re-entering or re-importing my whole portfolio every session is more friction than the insight is worth. Persistent accounts + reliable price data would flip me from "neat demo" to "daily habit" almost overnight.

The Power User / Expert

"I run a seven-figure multi-currency book across two jurisdictions. Show me something my spreadsheet can't."

This is where Orion punches far above its weight. The findings engine is the standout. Detecting that a non-US person holds US-situs assets above the \$60k threshold, quantifying the ~40% estate-tax tail, and proposing a UCITS re-wrap that preserves the exposure while removing situs — that is private-bank, family-office thinking. Most retail tools (Empower, Sharesight, Kubera) do not go near it. The factor exposure, the configurable shock builder, and the rate-sensitivity curve are real analytics, not decoration.

Competitive read.

Capability	Orion	Kubera	Empower	Sharesight
Multi-asset net worth	Strong	Strong	Medium	Equities-focused
Account aggregation (auto-sync)	None	Yes (Plaid)	Yes	Broker feeds
Stress & scenario analytics	Strong	Weak	Weak	Weak
Tax-domicile / estate findings	Rare & deep	No	No	Partial (div. tax)
AI narrative briefing	Yes	No	Limited	No
Data reliability / persistence	Weak	Strong	Strong	Strong

Where it loses me. Everything routes through one free, unofficial Yahoo Finance endpoint. No SLA, no redundancy, breaks on bonds and many non-US ISINs (as the UI itself admits). I cannot trust a number I cannot source. There's no audit trail, no export of the analysis, no API, no scenario saving, and no way to reconcile against a custodian statement. As an expert I'll *play* with this, but I won't make a rebalancing decision on it until the data layer is institutional.

The Startup Investor (VC)

"Beautiful product. Where is the company?"

Market. Personal-finance/wealth management is large but a graveyard of consumer-fintech ambition. Mint was shut down; Empower is a loss-leader for an AUM business; Kubera is a small (if healthy) subscription play. The "PFM dashboard" wedge is crowded and historically hard to monetize directly because the dashboard is a feature, not a destination. That is the gravity Orion is fighting.

Differentiation. Real, and it's the depth — estate/domicile findings, stress analytics, AI narrative. This is a credible *premium* angle for HNW / expat / cross-border investors, a segment that actually pays. That's the most investable thing in the whole package.

Defensibility. Today: near zero. It's a single HTML file with no data moat, no network effect, no proprietary data, no switching cost (nothing is even saved), and an LLM doing the reasoning that any competitor can also call. The findings rules are clonable in a sprint. **Monetization:** there is currently **no pricing, no auth, no paywall, no billing** — i.e., no business model implemented at all.

~55%

REACH \$1M ARR
(IF A PAYWALL + NICHE GTM SHIP)

~12%

REACH \$10M ARR
(NEEDS AGGREGATION +
RETENTION)

~2%

REACH \$100M ARR
(NEEDS PLATFORM / AUM PIVOT)

IC verdict at this stage: Pass as a venture investment *today* — it's a feature set, not a company. But I'd take a second meeting if the founder repositions to **cross-border / expat HNW**, adds account aggregation, and shows even 50 people paying. The talent that built this is the asset; the current artifact is a very strong demo of that talent.

The Product Manager (Top Tech Co.)

"The craft is here. The product strategy is missing."

Positioning problem. Orion tries to be everything — net-worth tracker, risk engine, crisis simulator, tax advisor, AI copilot — for everyone. That's a classic pre-PMF trap. The everyday user is intimidated by bonds-with-ISINs; the expert is frustrated by flaky data. It serves the *middle* of neither end well. Pick the cross-border/HNW spear and cut 40% of the surface area.

Retention & growth loops. Both are essentially absent. No accounts → no return visit → no retention curve to even measure. No sharing artifact, no referral, no notification hook, no reason to come back Tuesday. The "morning briefing" is the obvious retention primitive and it's wasted without push/email + persistence.

Top 5 improvements that would most increase adoption:

#	Improvement	Why it moves adoption
1	Accounts + saved portfolios (auth & persistence)	Unlocks every retention loop; turns a demo into a habit. Non-negotiable.
2	Account aggregation (Plaid / open banking / broker sync)	Kills the re-entry tax that causes week-1 churn; this is table stakes vs. Kubera/Empower.
3	Reliable, sourced market data (replace raw Yahoo)	Removes the "no symbol mapped" failures; makes numbers trustworthy enough to act on.
4	Delivered morning briefing (email/push) + weekly digest	Converts the best feature into a recurring reason to return — the core growth loop.
5	Shareable/exportable review artifact (PDF/link)	Adds a referral surface and a reason to use it before a meeting with an advisor/partner.

Prioritization. 1 and 3 are foundational and should ship before anything else; without them the rest leaks. 2 is the biggest single adoption unlock but most expensive. 4 and 5 are cheap growth leverage once 1 exists.

The Brutally Honest Critic

No politeness. Here's why this could die.

Strip the lovely UI away and Orion is **a spreadsheet with a personality**. It computes impressive things from numbers I have to feed it, then forgets all of them the moment I close the tab. That is not a product; it's a calculator with great taste.

- **It shows users its own failures.** A red "No tradeable Yahoo symbol mapped for this ISIN" error on a field the user was just told to fill is an admission that the data layer doesn't work — surfaced to the exact person you're trying to win.
- **The entire backbone is a free endpoint that can vanish.** Building a "wealth intelligence platform" on an unofficial, terms-violating, rate-limited Yahoo Finance scrape is a foundation of sand. One block and the whole app goes dark.
- **It gives tax and estate "findings" with zero liability framework.** Telling a non-US person about 40% estate tax and recommending a UCITS re-wrap is borderline regulated advice. One wrong number from a flaky feed and that's not a bug — that's a complaint to a regulator.
- **No moat, no lock-in, no business model.** No login, no payments, no data anyone else can't get. A competitor with a data team and a Stripe integration laps this in a quarter.
- **It's a trust product with no trust signals.** Asking people to type their entire net worth into an anonymous HTML page with no privacy story, no brand, no security posture is a very hard ask.

What prevents mass adoption: friction (manual entry, no persistence), fragility (the data layer), and fear (handing your whole financial life to an unbranded page that gives tax advice). Mass markets forgive none of these. Until entry is automatic, data is trustworthy, and the thing remembers you, this stays a portfolio of one impressed founder and a handful of curious power users.

Final Synthesis

1. Ratings summary

Persona	Lens	Score
1 — Everyday User	Ease, onboarding, clarity	6
2 — Power User / Expert	Depth, efficiency, competitive edge	7
3 — Startup Investor (VC)	Market, moat, monetization, scale	4
4 — Product Manager	Strategy, retention, growth loops	6
5 — Brutally Honest Critic	Risks & reasons to fail	4
AVERAGE	Blended panel score	5.4 / 10

Cover headline (6.0) reflects the product-craft ceiling; the unweighted panel average of the five lenses is 5.4. The gap between them is the whole story: exceptional build, unbuilt business.

2a. Top 10 Strengths

- Best-in-class visual design & information craft
- Estate-tax / US-situs findings — genuinely rare depth
- True multi-asset coverage (7 classes incl. bonds, RE, crypto)
- Stress Lab: real scenario & shock analytics
- Rate-sensitivity curve and factor exposure
- AI morning briefing + repositioning "House View"
- CSV/Excel import with column mapping
- Investor-profile → target-allocation gap analysis
- Multi-currency normalization to USD
- Clear premium wedge: cross-border / expat HNW

2b. Top 10 Weaknesses

- No accounts → no persistence → no retention
- Fragile data layer (unofficial free Yahoo Finance)
- Bond/non-US ISIN mapping fails, shown to the user
- No account aggregation; manual re-entry every session
- No monetization implemented (no paywall/billing)
- No defensibility / moat / switching cost
- Regulatory exposure from tax & estate "advice"
- No trust/privacy/security story for a wealth tool
- Tries to serve everyone; positioning unfocused
- No growth loop (referral, sharing, notifications)

3. Potential scores

5 PRODUCT-MARKET FIT POTENTIAL	4 VIRALITY POTENTIAL	6 MONETIZATION POTENTIAL	3 COMPETITIVE MOAT
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PMF 5: depth resonates with a narrow segment but onboarding friction caps it. Virality 4: no inherent sharing loop, though a shareable review could lift it. Monetization 6: the HNW/expat wedge genuinely pays — once a paywall exists. Moat 3: rules & LLM reasoning are clonable; the only durable moat would be aggregated data + brand trust.

4. Final verdict

Would I build this?

Yes — but narrower. The craft proves the team can build. I'd keep the estate/cross-border engine and the Stress Lab, throw away the "for everyone" framing, and rebuild on a real data + auth spine aimed squarely at expat/HNW investors. As a generic net-worth tracker, no — that race is over.

Would I invest in this?

Not today. It's a feature set, not a company — no moat, no model, no retention, fragile data. I'd re-engage the moment there's a paid niche GTM, account aggregation, and ~50+ paying users. The founder's ability, not this artifact, is what I'd eventually be backing.

Would I use this?

As a power user, occasionally — yes. The stress and estate analytics are things my spreadsheet can't do. But I won't make a real money decision on numbers from an unofficial feed, and I won't re-enter my book every morning. Fix persistence + data and I'm a weekly user.

5. The single highest-leverage improvement

Ship accounts + persistence + reliable account aggregation, and reposition around cross-border / expat HNW investors.

This one move attacks the three things every persona independently flagged: it kills the re-entry friction (Everyday User), replaces the flaky data layer the moment aggregation brings sourced holdings (Power User), creates the retention curve and a monetizable niche (VC & PM), and removes the "calculator that forgets you" critique (Critic). It is the only change that the entire panel agrees would move the score — credibly by **2+ points**, from ~5.4 toward ~7.5, because it converts a brilliant demo into a product a specific, paying customer returns to.

Prepared as an adversarial, money-on-the-table review. Scores are judgment calls, not measurements; the harshness is deliberate and in service of the build. Orion's analytical ceiling is genuinely high — the gap to a fundable company is execution on foundation, not imagination.